



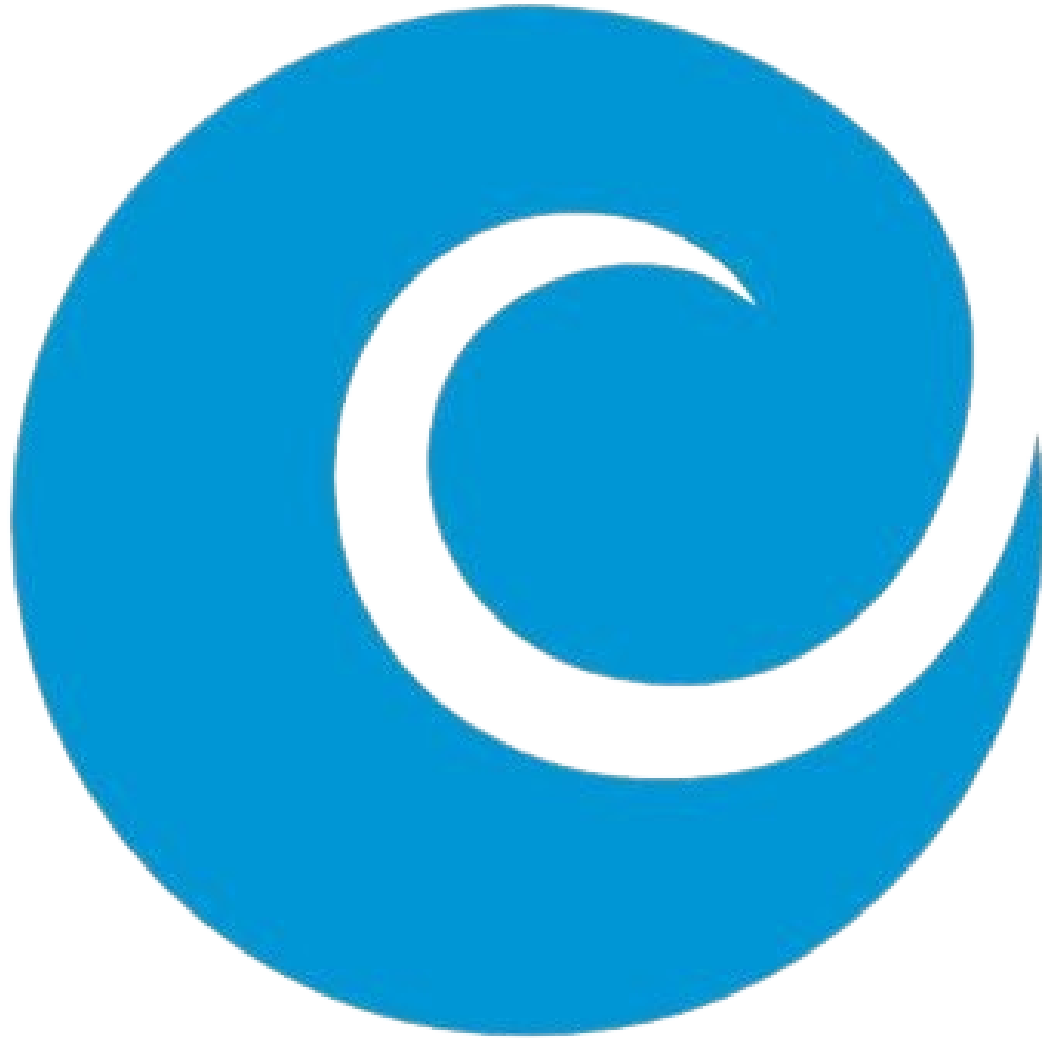
Storytelling in the Digital Age

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Integrated Media Project

Andres Mona.

Collab project between MMJC 9104 & 9200.



- ***LINK TO
PROJECT AND
WEBSITE.***

<https://andresmona.wordpress.com/2023/12/03/integrated-media-project/>

Topic – Why and Personal Connection

- **Topic:** Opioid Crisis in London – Current and ongoing relief efforts in the city. Use an NPO as an example. LIHC as an example.
- The objective of my project was to look at the operation of the LIHC (London Intercommunity Health Clinics) and to interview three of their frontline workers to learn about their experiences, the status of the crisis and the challenges they face.
- I have worked in the past with Project Hope, an NPO that provides survival essentials to the at-risk populace. I have also worked in care homes alongside frontline workers in the GTA during the pandemic. I am currently in training with the foodbank to become a Client support worker.
- Also, and more personally I have also had substance abuse issues in the past. It is important to be aware and to make others aware of what is being done to deal with a crisis that affects the London community.

Structure, Planning and Research

- **Story structured around LIHC and three characters that work with organization.**
- **Products:**
 - 3 broadcast style interviews, radio story with 3 parts.
 - 3 complementary articles.
 - 3 infographics.
 - 2 essays.
 - Website page with project overview, resource page to other links and media archive.
- **Three people were interviewed:**
 - John Philip Chua, Client Support Worker
 - Richard MacDonagh, Program Coordinator Infectious Disease Team
 - Paige Logan, Harm Reduction Worker
- **Interviewees were asked the following questions:** What do you do? What does your work entail with the LIHC? How long have you done this work? What have you seen and/or experienced during that time – has the situation worsened? What challenges do your clients face getting tested (for HIV/HEPC)/treatment? What might dissuade them from seeking help or seeking treatment?

Challenges and Ethical Dilemmas

- The first consideration was the accuracy and information presented. This is a sensitive topic that has affected many in the country and London community. Subjects must be treated with accurate and careful language.
- Foundations of research come from Government of Canada stats and from frontline workers themselves in the LIHC. LIHC also provided brochures (available on the website) for more info regarding overdose rates and services available.
- Originally, I wanted to film a series of short videos, showing actual on-the-ground operations with the LIHC. There was difficulty however with scheduling and the staffing shortages being faced in social work. Equally, it was advised to not interview a client of the LIHC, to respect privacy and to follow the advice of the LIHC's HR.
- Scheduling was also a major issue as NPOs in the city are struggling to keep up with the increasing demands of the at-risk populace.



The Issue of Exaggeration and Inaccuracy

- Stay away from exaggerations or presenting London as a dystopia.
- Such a project definitely must base itself heavily on expert knowledge and from frontline work experience.
- Personal opinions and perspectives are minimal in this project as the objective is to demonstrate others lived and situated experiences.
- The project also puts a lot of emphasis of the expertise of the interviewees and their views regarding the Opioid crisis: what needs to be done

Findings & Conclusions

- Ultimately, what I found from this project is that the Opioid crisis is here to stay... likely for many decades more.
- The situation is worsening, according to experts; however, efforts and operations have also increased in the last 3 or so years.
- The LIHC runs some of the largest outreach programs in the city and many clients are not substance abusers.
- However, substance abuse plays a tremendous role in destabilizing a person's life and therefore a multitude of services are used due to the ongoing crisis.
- Shortages in staffing, increase in the potency and availability of narcotics, COVID-19, and the housing crisis are just some factors that have exacerbated the